# United Kingdom: energy security, economic opportunity and partnership priorities

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*AI-generated from the data and checked against it; paper baseline as of 12 October 2026.*


## Summary

- The United Kingdom is most exposed in downstream coal, downstream oil and downstream gas, where its Energy Security is higher than only 0%, 1% and 9% of the other economies scored. Low consumption and energy access scores pull these down.[1]
- Its strongest openings are in downstream electric vehicles and downstream batteries, where its Economic Opportunity is higher than 92% and 86% of the other economies scored, both lifted by investment.[1]
- On the paper's weighting, its top Strategic Index sectors are upstream nuclear, upstream solar and downstream batteries. Comparing priority with policy, midstream batteries is top priority with the most policy; upstream electric vehicles is top priority with the least policy.[1]
- The Partnership Strength Index rates the United States highest for the United Kingdom, a reliable supplier and its 1st trade partner. China, its 3rd trade partner, ranks 48th.[1,2]


## 1. Energy security risks and why

Of the United Kingdom's 25 placed sectors, those comparable with other economies, 4 sit in the two low-energy-security corners. All 4 are in the Secure corner, which pairs low energy security with low opportunity. The paper's framework, after RMI (2025), associates the Secure corner with securing supply through trusted partners.[1]

Energy Security measures how well a country can rely on what it needs. Its lowest Energy Security percentiles are in downstream coal, downstream oil, downstream gas and upstream nuclear. It scores higher than only 0%, 1% and 9% of the other 98 economies scored in each downstream sector, and higher than 11% of the other 174 in upstream nuclear.[1]

Its top Strategic Index sector is upstream nuclear. There its Energy Security score of 0.16 sits just below the sector's median of 0.17, in the Secure corner. The gap to the median mainly reflects its trade category. Its trade deficit in these goods came to <0.1% of GDP in 2023, a measure on which it scores higher than only 2% of the other economies. No reserves are recorded for the United Kingdom, which the index counts as zero, as for the median economy. For context, its largest suppliers in 2024 were Canada (51.1% of its imports) and the United States (48.9%).[1,2,3]

In downstream coal, the score is low mainly because of its consumption and energy access categories, and part of the consumption data is filled in with the world average. Its consumption in this sector was 0.714 GJ per person in 2025, and its change in consumption per person was -78.7%. In downstream oil, the same consumption category pulls the score down most. On expected growth in use per person and on use per person today, it scores higher than only 2% and 2% of the other economies.[1,4]

## 2. Economic opportunities and why

The United Kingdom's openings are broad: 16 of its placed sectors sit in the two high-opportunity corners, all of them in the Grow corner, which pairs high opportunity with high energy security. The paper's framework, after RMI (2025), associates the Grow corner with export promotion.[1]

Economic Opportunity measures how well placed a country is to create value. Its highest Economic Opportunity percentiles are in downstream electric vehicles, downstream batteries, upstream solar and midstream electric vehicles. It scores higher than 92%, 86%, 86% and 80% of the other economies scored in these sectors, respectively.[1]

In downstream electric vehicles, the score is high mainly because of investment and technology demand. On annual investment it scores higher than 97% of the other economies, and on the expected size and growth of domestic demand higher than 89%. In downstream batteries, investment pushes the score up: on annual investment it scores higher than 97% of the other economies.[1]

In midstream electric vehicles, investment and trade push the score up. Its exports of these goods reached USD 29.8 bn in 2024, and its revealed comparative advantage is 1.28: above the neutral value, so these goods weigh more in its exports than in world trade. For context, its largest markets for these goods in 2024 were the United States (25.5%) and Germany (11.4%).[2,5]

## 3. Sectoral priorities and the existing policy posture

The Strategic Index ranks a country's own sectors by opportunity, security need, policy activity, stage and technology. On the paper's weighting, it ranks upstream nuclear 1st among the United Kingdom's own sectors, scoring 0.66, 0.013 ahead of the next. Its security-need term, 0.251, outweighs its opportunity term, 0.152. Next come upstream solar (2nd), downstream batteries (3rd) and upstream wind (4th), each almost tied with the next (0.009, 0.008 and 0.004 apart).[1]

In the allied network design, the paper's model of shared coalition production, a member's allied pick is its best-ranked upstream or midstream sector on the Strategic Index after a resource-base screen. The United Kingdom's upstream nuclear, upstream solar, upstream wind and upstream electric grid sectors have no recorded resource base, so its allied pick is midstream batteries, almost tied with midstream electric grid (0.004 apart).[6]

Setting the policy term aside and comparing priority with policy activity, midstream batteries and midstream electric grid are top priority with the most policy. The upstream electric vehicles sector is top priority with the least policy: 8th on priority but 18th on policy activity, with 3 International Energy Agency policy records naming its technology and stage. In downstream batteries, policy activity, where it ranks 1st, lifts the Strategic Index rank to 3rd from 11th without the policy term. At the bottom, 6 fossil-fuel sectors are bottom priority with the least policy.[1,7]

The Climate Action Tracker, an independent rating of climate action, rates the United Kingdom Insufficient overall (November 2024). The United Kingdom's 454 International Energy Agency policy records include 276 naming a technology.[7,8]

## 4. Partnership priorities and why

The Partnership Strength Index rates partners for the United Kingdom as a reliable supplier (Friendshore), an export market (Partnership Opportunity) and, for middle- and lower-income partners, a development partner

(Development Potential). It rates the United States, France, Germany, the Netherlands and Canada highest, ranked 1st to 5th.[1]

The United States, France and Germany rank best as a reliable supplier; the Netherlands and Canada as an export market. As a supplier, the United States scores best in downstream gas, upstream nuclear, downstream coal, downstream solar and downstream oil: the United Kingdom's lowest Energy Security sectors.[1]

The index and today's trade largely agree. On average across its energy-goods baskets in 2024, the United States is its 1st trade partner, Germany its 2nd, France its 4th, the Netherlands its 6th and Canada its 8th. Each is a priority partner with strong ties today. The United Kingdom shares the G7, NATO and the Minerals Security Partnership with the United States, and they vote in the same bloc at the United Nations. An exception is China, its 3rd trade partner: a strong tie today that the index ranks lower (48th), and they vote in opposite blocs at the United Nations.[1,2,9,10]

As a partner to the coalition, the United Kingdom itself ranks 4th of 192 economies. In the allied network design, it holds 11.5% of the coalition's designed production in upstream solar, and 5.0% in midstream batteries, its allied pick.[1,6]

## 5. Data notes and caveats

Baseline as of 12 October 2026; details on the Country Insights page. Scores compare the United Kingdom with other economies in the same sector; they are not measures of risk or profit in absolute terms. All index values are the paper's baseline as of 12 October 2026; Strategic Insights recomputes them under other weightings. Some figures behind these scores are filled in where the source has no value: with zero where a source lists every holder, otherwise with the world average. Strategic Index scores within 0.01 of each other are almost tied: small changes in the data or the weights can swap their order. Where the United Kingdom or a partner did not report a flow, it is read from the other side's report, raised by 6% to value it like imports. Many allied picks are close calls: in the paper, 37% of them are within 0.01 of the runner-up.

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Sources


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